Alejandro Magno Fernandini

Experience Designer. Design systems and complex operational tools.

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PROFILE

Ten years in design and a working engineering background, focused on the internal systems people use all day to do difficult work. I own design systems, and I build prototypes that prove a design works before engineering commits to it.

I work in the double diamond: understand the problem, then design the solution. Agentic tools have made delivery faster, and with that comes the temptation to skip discovery. I don't, because fast work only pays off if it still holds up long after it ships.

SELECTED WORK

A system you can inspect, because the ones at work can't be shown. Every design system I've owned lives behind an employer's login. So I built one in the open, in code and in Figma, from what those systems taught me, and wrote down what every decision cost.
magnocreative.com/work/a-system-you-can-inspect

EXPERIENCE

JPMorganChase

PLANO, TEXAS

Experience Designer

JUNE 2024 TO PRESENT

- Led design and documentation for the platform's self-service portal, a reference product other lines of business use to adopt shared CRM patterns. Rated exceeding expectations; partners credited the work with high project impact.
- Own and maintain the Salesforce Lightning Design System used by every CRM team in the group: component architecture, auto layout and slot patterns, and the usage documentation designers work from.
- Drove the analysis behind the team's decision to leave Salesforce and build an in-house design system, after the vendor's platform shift left the existing system unable to meet cross-line-of-business needs.
- Replaced static prototypes with coded ones, removing a translation step between design and engineering. Built the workflow, the components and the specification format, established the team's first version-controlled workspace, and taught both to the team.

Software Engineer

NOVEMBER 2022 TO JUNE 2024

- Maintained and updated the SQL jobs behind the bank's submission for the Federal Reserve's Comprehensive Capital Analysis and Review, the annual stress test that sets how much capital a large bank must hold. Daily run cycle handed to a team in India overnight, working to a fixed month-end delivery date.
- Automating parts of the pipeline made it faster and more fragile. Rebuilt the jobs so they stopped breaking, shipping each fix through a verification deployment before production. Stability was the goal, and month-end data went out on schedule.

USAA

SAN ANTONIO AND PLANO, TEXAS

Designer

OCTOBER 2018 TO NOVEMBER 2022

- Designed across governance, risk and compliance, audit, and enterprise reporting: internal platforms where the users are specialists and the cost of a bad interface is measured in rework and missed controls.
- Surveyed 82 people across a compliance organization running on sixteen interconnected applications, and found the problem was not the applications. Nobody could tell when any of them was down or in maintenance.
- Designed the consolidated status view that replaced checking sixteen systems by hand. Shipped to several hundred staff and still in use, with a feedback channel inside it so what got built next came from the people using it.
- Recommended a common design language across all sixteen applications. When platform leadership chose to keep each system's defaults, redesigned the approach to deliver value without requiring sixteen teams to migrate.

HCL Technologies

ON-SITE AT USAA, SAN ANTONIO, TEXAS

Visual Designer

FEBRUARY 2017 TO OCTOBER 2018

- Designed web pages for USAA's public site within the bank team, and prototyped concepts for USAA Labs that directors used to socialize new ideas internally. Converted to a full-time USAA role at the end of the engagement.

CAREER PRIOR TO 2017

Graphic designer and technical illustrator roles at SWBC and Elbit Systems of America, 2013 to 2017.

SKILLS

Design systems	Component architecture, design tokens, auto layout and slot patterns, usage documentation, adoption and governance across teams
Product design	Discovery, user research and interviews, information architecture, interaction design, prototyping, accessibility (WCAG)
Design engineering	Coded prototypes, version control and branching workflows, AI-assisted prototyping, design-to-engineering handoff
Tools	Figma, VS Code, Storybook, Salesforce Lightning Design System, Jira, FigJam, Adobe Creative Suite

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Fine Arts, Computer Graphic Arts — 2015
University of the Incarnate Word